

# Web Design Brief



Dec 2025

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# Competitive Analysis

To better understand our competitive strengths and weaknesses we can compare the existing website to one of our top competitors. While Upright Citizen's Brigade are not local, they are one of the most famous improv schools in North America. How can we catch up to their example?

## Google PageSpeed Insights

Below we review metrics from Google PageSpeed Insights. All observations are based on crawls of the respective site homepages.

| Performance                                                                              | Accessibility                                                                            | Search Engine Optimization                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>UCB mobile - 41</li><li>UCB desktop - 31</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>UCB mobile - 92</li><li>UCB desktop - 92</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>UCB mobile - 92</li><li>UCB desktop - 85</li></ul> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>BTC mobile - 64</li><li>BTC desktop - 67</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>BTC mobile - 79</li><li>BTC desktop - 82</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>BTC mobile - 85</li><li>BTC desktop - 85</li></ul> |

### Performance

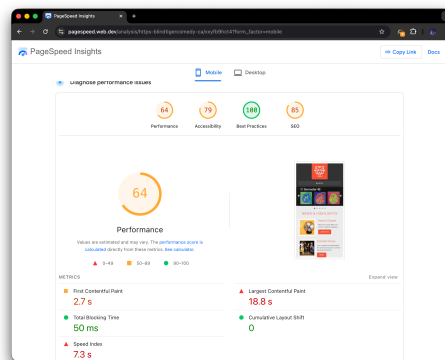
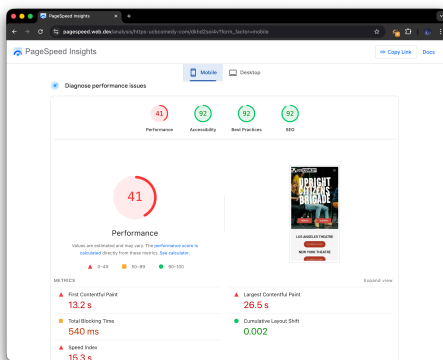
- BTC's existing site is clearly faster than UCB's on both mobile and desktop. And there's lots of room to grow this score with a new site.

### Accessibility

- According to an automated analysis, UCB has the edge over BTC on accessibility. (Caveat: The deficiencies identified on BTC are minor and easily rectified.)

### Search Engine Optimization

- Both sites are evenly matched in their present state.



# Competitive Analysis

## Wappalyzer

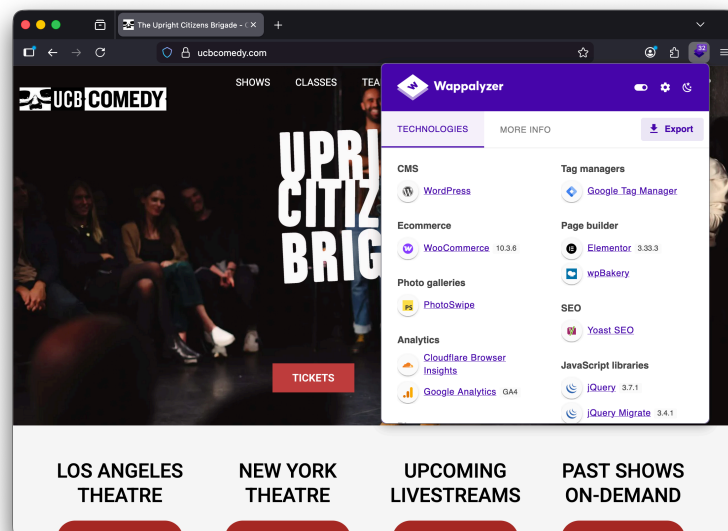
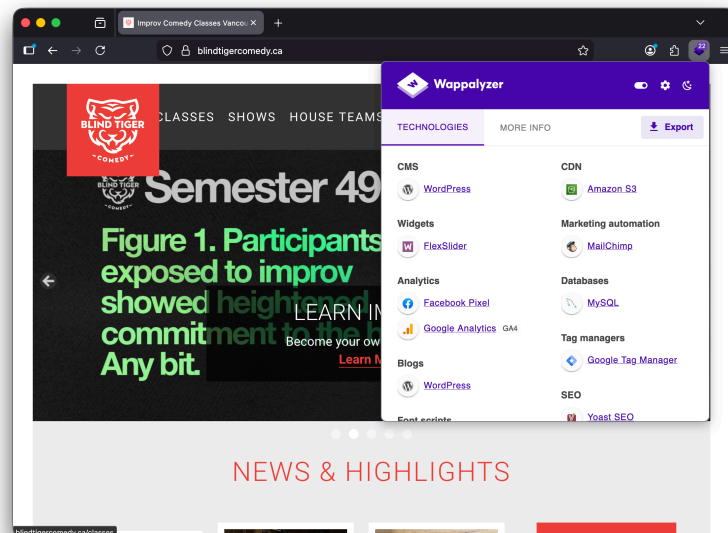
Wappalyzer is a browser plugin that detects technologies and services connected to the currently browsed website. Here's some selected highlights from comparing BTC to UCB.

### Key similarities

- BTC and UCB both currently utilize WordPress, MySQL database and Yoast SEO plugin.

### UCB advantages

- Commerce, calendar, and ticketing: Tickera, The Events Calendar and Stripe (payment gateway) are detected on this site.
- Shows are displayed in a sortable/searchable calendar system.
- Tickets can be purchased directly on-site.



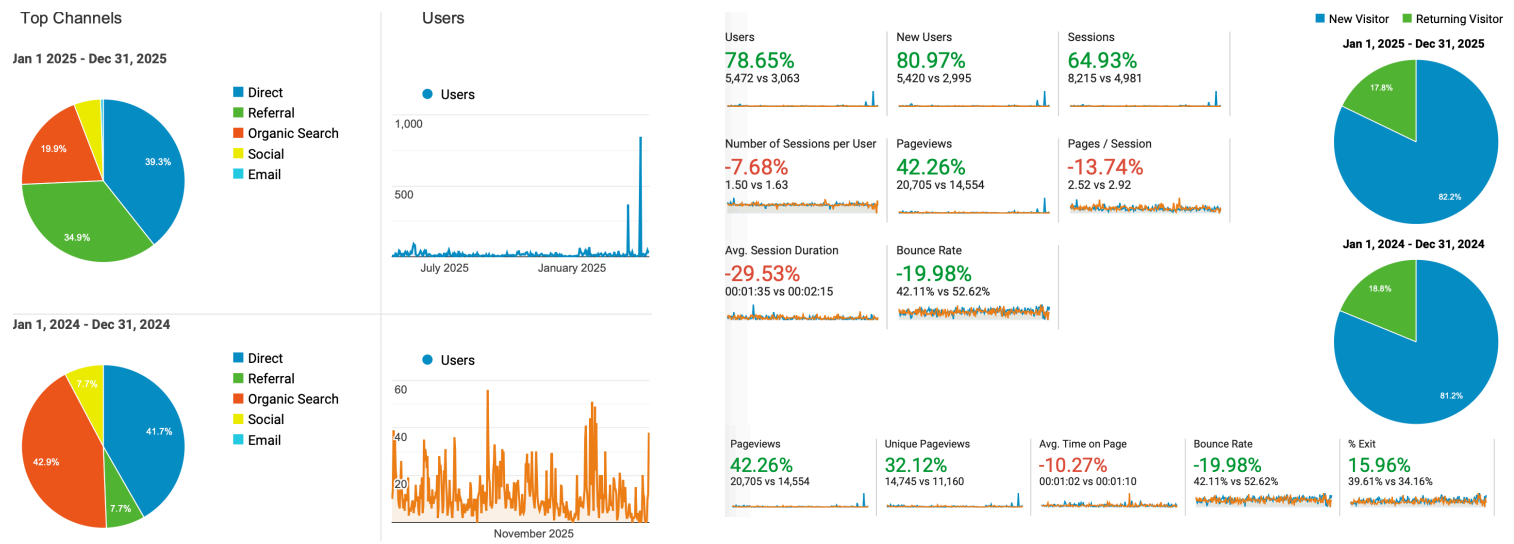


# Baseline Statistics

We expect to see a return on investment as a result of this engagement. But how can we objectively measure our results? We start by collecting some basic information about the historical performance of the existing website. While not a controlled experiment, using this metrics post-engagement can give us a general sense of whether we're headed in the right direction.

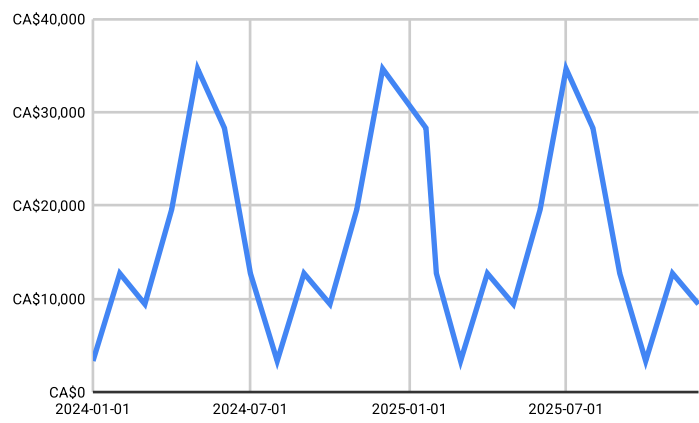
## Google Analytics

Based on Google Analytics data for Acquisition Overview, Audience Overview and Pageview data. All data compares 2025 to 2024 year over year.



## Gross Sales

Based on available 2024-2025 data. Data combines show ticketing and student tuition revenues, with an estimated 50/50 split between the two.



# Baseline Statistics

## Mailchimp

Data is filtered for the list "Newsletter for Customers".

| Send Date      | Good Deliveries | Unique Opens | Open Rate |
|----------------|-----------------|--------------|-----------|
| 1/6/25 12:45   | 661             | 256          | 39%       |
| 1/7/25 11:27   | 661             | 242          | 37%       |
| 1/8/25 9:56    | 660             | 220          | 33%       |
| 1/15/25 9:15   | 655             | 228          | 35%       |
| 1/20/25 11:29  | 657             | 180          | 27%       |
| 1/22/25 14:38  | 657             | 233          | 35%       |
| 2/2/25 14:41   | 660             | 250          | 38%       |
| 2/23/25 15:38  | 658             | 215          | 33%       |
| 2/27/25 9:00   | 660             | 212          | 32%       |
| 3/27/25 8:45   | 661             | 262          | 40%       |
| 3/31/25 12:01  | 660             | 231          | 35%       |
| 4/14/25 19:29  | 659             | 250          | 38%       |
| 4/16/25 17:04  | 658             | 254          | 39%       |
| 4/21/25 20:29  | 660             | 222          | 34%       |
| 4/24/25 16:02  | 657             | 231          | 35%       |
| 4/27/25 8:15   | 656             | 207          | 32%       |
| 5/1/25 8:45    | 654             | 190          | 29%       |
| 5/22/25 17:10  | 652             | 248          | 38%       |
| 5/26/25 8:45   | 651             | 178          | 27%       |
| 6/1/25 8:45    | 650             | 206          | 32%       |
| 6/15/25 17:40  | 654             | 206          | 32%       |
| 6/23/25 9:30   | 652             | 178          | 27%       |
| 7/6/25 16:18   | 653             | 202          | 31%       |
| 7/27/25 15:22  | 650             | 225          | 35%       |
| 8/24/25 14:40  | 649             | 259          | 40%       |
| 8/31/25 9:15   | 650             | 215          | 33%       |
| 9/3/25 0:06    | 650             | 223          | 34%       |
| 9/8/25 9:45    | 648             | 174          | 27%       |
| 9/18/25 14:04  | 651             | 209          | 32%       |
| 9/22/25 9:15   | 653             | 195          | 30%       |
| 9/23/25 10:15  | 651             | 195          | 30%       |
| 10/14/25 13:05 | 648             | 216          | 33%       |
| 10/21/25 21:38 | 647             | 262          | 40%       |
| 11/2/25 11:31  | 643             | 197          | 31%       |
| 11/5/25 9:00   | 643             | 147          | 23%       |
| 11/12/25 8:45  | 648             | 178          | 27%       |
| 11/15/25 12:41 | 649             | 191          | 29%       |
| 12/3/25 10:28  | 651             | 197          | 30%       |

### Key stats

- Average of 253.6 successful deliveries.
- Average of 215.4 unique opens.
- Average 33% open rate.

# Company Goals

What do we wish to achieve in this engagement? Below we will formalize the scope of our work and our mutually agreed upon definition of success.

## Key Success Metrics

- Support a 25% growth of show ticket revenues for 2026 (compared to 2025).
- Support a minimum of 80% capacity for all 2026 intro-level courses and taster sessions to ensure the long-term health of the education program.
- Double engaged newsletter subscribers (compared to 2025) while maintaining or exceeding average 2025 open rates.

## Tactics

### **Focus website on two calls to action**

- The most important and common things for a visitor to do is get tickets to a show or sign up for a class. Users should be able to easily start either workflow from the homepage (above the fold).
- The next 1-3 shows and their ticketing information are available on the homepage, above the fold.
- The next intro-level improv course and taster session are available on the homepage, above the fold.

### **Integrate a searchable and filterable events calendar**

- Provide separate calendars for shows and classes.
- Make it easy for people to share direct links to a specific event's info with friends and fans.
- Integrates useful filtering solutions depending on the use case (fan vs. student). Examples for prospective students: date range, location, price, genre, etc.

### **Integrate an on-site ticketing workflow**

- Allow users to purchase show tickets without leaving the BTC website (except for customers logging into their payment services such as PayPal).

### **Maximize website performance**

- The new website's homepage will launch with PageSpeed Insight scores of 90 or above for both Desktop and Mobile.

### **Prioritize Search Engine Optimization**

- Conduct keyword analysis for 2-3 high value keywords, collect baseline SERP performance data, monitor performance monthly, and make monthly enhancements to maintain ranks.

# Tasks

What good is a website if they aren't helping people with what they need and want? Our task list is a compass for this engagement so that we build something useful and delightful.

## Get to the show/class

As a student or fan, get timely location and contact information so they can be in the right place at the right time.

## Get tickets

Buy tickets for the next (or upcoming) a comedy show.

## Research shows & classes

For folks who may become fans or students.

## Sign up

Enroll in a comedy class.

## Stay connected

Sign up for the BTC mailing list.

## Get to know BTC

Learn about instructors and house teams.

# Archetypes

We're making one website that addresses the needs of substantially different user groups. These groups are organized into archetypes so that we can ensure our final product serves their objectives with minimal friction.

## Emerging performers

Pursuing a creative passion.

## Professional performers

Wanting to sharpen their skills for future work opportunities.

## Local comedy fans

Wanting fun and art absent screens.

## Friends and family

Attends student showcase shows to support their loved ones.

## Corporate event planners

Has a team building budget they want to use in a memorable and morale boosting way.

## Faculty

Needs to keep track of their colleagues, shows and future class intakes.

# Persona & Scenario

User experience means getting into the mindset, needs and wants of our users. By imagining a representative persona of and scenario for an ideal user, we're able to keep our marketing efforts aligned with them.

## Alex



30 years old, in a long-term relationship, no children.

### The dream

Joining a local improv troupe and performing at a Vancouver comedy fest.

### Key facts

- Her friends call her “the funny one”.
- Goes to 3-4 Little Mountain Gallery shows a year with friends.
- Listens to the Comedy Bang Bang podcast weekly.
- Works as a junior developer at a software startup.
- Commutes via Skytrain into Vancouver from Surrey.
- Played Officer Krupke in a high school drama production of West Side Story.

### Wants and needs

- A creative outlet.
- Hungry for stimulating offline experiences.
- Needs to fit classes in around a challenging work schedule.

### Fears

- Doesn't know where to start.
- Imposter syndrome.
- Afraid of letting her instructor or classmates down.
- Hostile education environments.
- Bombing on stage in front of her friends.

## Scenario

One evening at the gym Alex makes a resolution to herself: she will try improv comedy by the end of the year. She pulls out her iPhone and Googles “Vancouver improv school”. She notes the top three organic results: Blind Tiger Comedy, The Improv Center, and Tightrope Theatre.

After reviewing them all, BTC's website is the standout. It has a polished and on-trend aesthetic, which Alex appreciates as a software professional. And the homepage was ready to meet her needs immediately, right above the fold. A callout invites “people new to comedy” to learn about the Intro 1 class, which promises that no experience is required.

The details page for Intro I loads quickly. The page promises a safe and fun environment. An on-page widget highlights the next three intakes for Intro I, describing the dates, times, locations and instructors. Sundays at 6pm sounds like a fit. She taps the “register” button and enters registration details and payment information, paying instantly with Apple Pay. She's redirected to a thank you page detailing next steps and key contact info.

# Concept Map

A thorough design process considers the core ideas of a brand experience and its customer relationships. Below we explore BTC's core offerings of classes and shows, which result in student registrations and fan ticket sales respectively.

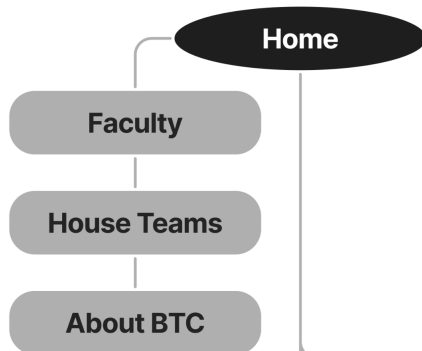


# Sitemap & Facets

Understanding the sitemap of the new site will inform all design and development activities to follow. A description of searchable facets will inform designers and developers about UI that allows the user to narrow offerings to their specific needs.

## Home page

- Above the fold: Show or Class?
- This week's shows
- Callout to Improv Intro 1 class
- Overview and social feeds for BTC



## Classes landing/category landing facets

- Location (e.g. Granville Island, China Cloud Studios, Princess Avenue)
- Course duration: Day, 1 week, 5 weeks, 8 weeks
- Instructor
- Genre (Improv, Sketch, Stand Up)
- Experience level (Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced)
- Price

## Classes landing page

- Brief descriptions of each genre
- Callout to Improv Intro 1 class
- Calendar listing of classes

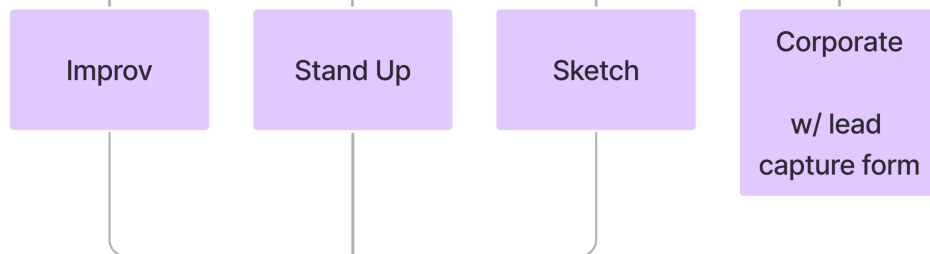
## Classes

## Show Calendar

- Highlight the next show
- Calendar of all upcoming shows

## Class category landing pages

- Introduce the genre
- Class descriptions
- Calendar listing for genre
- Highlight upcoming intakes



## Show details page

- Show description
- Cast info
- Location info
- Pricing

## Class details pages

- Detailed course description
- Instructor info
- Location info
- Pricing

## Class details page

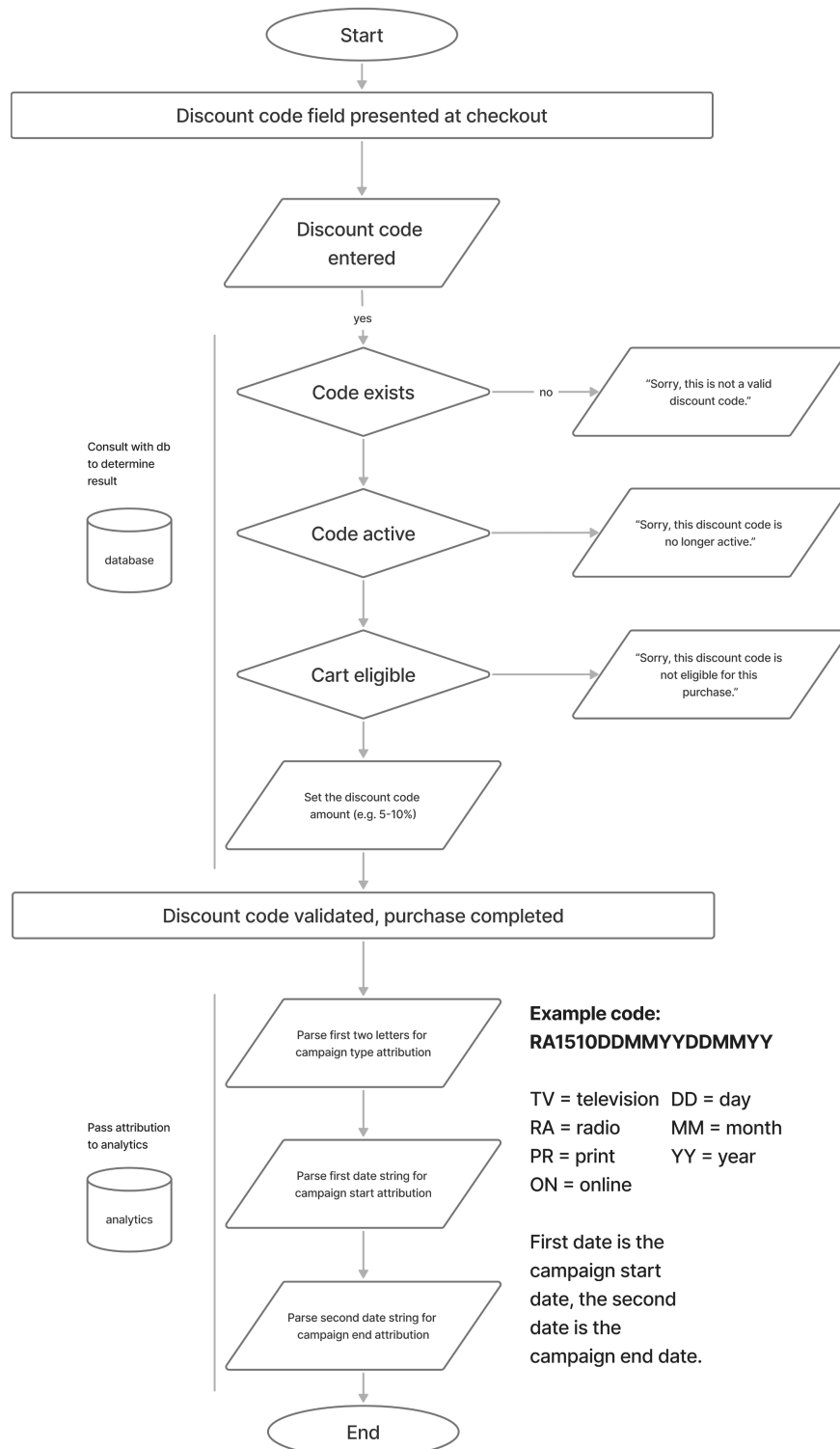
## Registration

## Ticketing



# User Flow

UX Design requires a detailed understanding of complex user workflows and how they interact with third-party and back-end technologies. In this example we detail the validation of and attribution for discount codes.



# SEO Meta Data

Embedding key meta data into a web page's HTML helps search engine crawlers surface your page, and also helps your users understand why your page is of use to them. The recommended code snippet below should be used on the new site's home page.

```
<head>
<title>Vancouver Improv Shows & Comedy Classes | Blind Tiger Comedy</title>
<meta name="description" content="Watch hilarious Vancouver improv comedy. Learn comedy and improv from beginner to pro.">
<meta name="keywords" content="improv classes, improv school, beginner improv, comedy classes vancouver, comedy school vancouver, improv shows vancouver, comedy shows vancouver, comedy workshops">
</head>
```

## Reference content

### Blind Tiger Comedy

```
<title>Improv and Sketch Comedy Shows - Blind Tiger Comedy</title>
<meta name="description" content="Blind Tiger's monthly calendar of hilarious improv and sketch comedy shows, featuring students, faculty, and our incredible house teams in Vancouver, BC." />
```

*No meta keywords tag. Retrieved from <https://blindtigercomedy.ca/> on December 4, 2025.*

### Upright Citizen's Brigade

```
<title>The Upright Citizens Brigade - Comedy Theatre and Training Center</title>
<meta name="description" content="The UCB is a world-renowned comedy theater and comedy school with live shows seven nights a week in Los Angeles. Tickets and classes on sale now." />
```

*No meta keywords tag. Retrieved from <https://ucbcomedy.com/> on December 4, 2025.*

### Google Gemini

```
<title>Vancouver Improv Comedy Shows & Classes | Theatre & School</title>
<meta name="description" content="See the best live improv and sketch comedy shows in Vancouver! Join a class for beginners, advanced, long-form improv, and stand-up comedy. Weekly performances & expert instruction at our theatre and school." />
<meta name="keywords" content="Vancouver comedy, Vancouver improv, improv classes, comedy theatre, comedy school, sketch comedy classes, stand up comedy classes, improv shows Vancouver, beginner improv, advanced improv, long form improv, Vancouver entertainment, comedy workshops" />
```

*Content placed in tags by the author. See Credits page for more info.*

# Credits

## Google

### Date

November 25, 2025

### Model

Gemini 3 Pro (Thinking)

### Prompt

Who are the competitors to <https://blindtigercomedy.ca/> in the city of Vancouver?

(Later cross-checked with Google SERP.)

### Date

December 4, 2025

### Model

"Fast"

### Prompt

For search engine optimization purposes, suggest title, meta description and meta keywords tags for a Vancouver comedy and improv theatre and school. Improv comedy shows are offered weekly. Classes are available for beginner, advanced and long-form improvisational comedy as well as sketch comedy and stand up comedy.

Keep the title tag under 70 characters long.

Keep the meta description under 250 characters long.

Keep the meta keywords tag under 500 characters long.

## Analysis

Wappalyzer (Firefox extension)

FigJam (flowcharts, misc. graphics)

Google Sheets (pivot table and sales chart)

Google Analytics (website data)

Mailchimp

## Photos

"smiling woman in black tank top" by Luca Nicoletti. <https://unsplash.com/photos/smiling-woman-in-black-tank-top-dzbSQkqZzUw>

## Disclaimer

This report is an educational exercise for the BCIT Front-End Web Developer program. No professional engagement with Blind Tiger Comedy took place.